

CLASSIFIED

ARCHIVE //
FINANCIAL INTELLIGENCE
DIVISION

FINTECH AND QUANT CLUB, NISM
P R E S E N T S

LOCKED FILES

Official Rules & Participant Handbook

EVERY ANSWER IS A KEY.

DATE	19 AUGUST 2026
COMPETITION START	5:50 PM ONWARDS
DURATION	3 HOURS
VENUE	BANQUET HALL, C-BLOCK, FIRST FLOOR
TEAM SIZE	MAXIMUM 5 PARTICIPANTS
MODE	ON-SITE, LAPTOP-BASED COMPETITION
FILE TYPE	ENCRYPTED SEQUENCE
STATUS	RESTRICTED

[THINK. DECODE. UNLOCK.]

FILE_01

1 ABOUT THE EVENT

Locked Files is a team-based analytical competition organized by the FinTech and Quant Club, NISM. The competition is designed to test participants' ability to think critically, identify patterns, solve problems, perform quantitative analysis, and apply knowledge of financial and securities markets under time pressure.

Challenges may involve:

- Securities Markets
- Finance
- Quantitative Reasoning
- Logical Deduction
- Data Interpretation
- Cryptography and Encoding
- Pattern Recognition
- FinTech

CORE MECHANISM · Question → Answer → Unlock → Next Question → Answer → Unlock → ...

Participants must solve each question to unlock the next challenge.

FILE_02

2 COMPETITION FORMAT

2.1 Teams

- Each team may consist of a maximum of 5 participants.
- Each participant may belong to only one registered team.
- Teams must remain together throughout the competition.
- Team members may freely discuss and solve questions among themselves.
- The organizers reserve the right to merge two or more teams, where required and deemed appropriate by the organizers, including for operational, logistical, or participation-related reasons. Any such decision shall be communicated to the affected participants and shall be final.

2.2 Duration

The competition will run for 2 hours, beginning at 5:50 PM. The competition will conclude at the end of the designated two-hour period. Participants are responsible for managing their own time.

2.3 The Locked Files Mechanism

The competition will be conducted through the designated Locked Files website. Teams will begin with the first challenge. A correct answer unlocks the next question, and teams must continue through the sequence until they complete the entire quest.

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3 OBJECTIVE

The objective is to complete the entire sequence of challenges accurately and in the shortest possible time.

THE COMPETITION REWARDS · Accuracy + Speed + Efficient Problem Solving

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4 PARTICIPANT EQUIPMENT

Participants are required to bring their own laptops for the competition.

- Each team must have access to at least one functional laptop capable of accessing the Locked Files website.
- Bring a fully charged laptop and its charger.
- Ensure that the browser is updated and functional.
- Carry a calculator for quantitative challenges.
- Test the device before the event.

The organizers will not be responsible for personal-device failures arising from insufficient battery, hardware problems, software issues, or other participant-side technical problems.

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5 WEBSITE & SCREEN REQUIREMENTS

The Locked Files website will be the sole platform for the competition. Participants must keep the website open in full-screen mode throughout the competition.

Participants are not permitted to:

- Open other browser tabs for assistance.
- Search for answers.
- Open external websites.
- Use online calculators.
- Access AI tools or chatbots.
- Access messaging or communication platforms.
- Use any other website or application for solving the challenges.

⚠ MONITORING

Tab switching and browser activity will be monitored. Unauthorized tab switching or access to restricted resources will result in penalties and may lead to disqualification, depending on the nature and severity of the violation.

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6 INTERNET USAGE

Internet connectivity will be available during the event solely for accessing and operating the Locked Files website.

Participants are strictly prohibited from using internet connectivity for any other purpose, including:

- Google or other search engines
- Financial websites
- ChatGPT or other AI tools
- Online calculators
- Wikipedia or other reference websites
- Social media
- Email
- Messaging services
- Any external website or online resource

⚠ IMPORTANT

Internet access does not imply permission to browse the internet. Failure to comply with this rule will result in disqualification.

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7 COLLABORATION

Locked Files is a team-based competition. Participants are encouraged to collaborate with members of their own team.

Teams may:

- Discuss questions.
- Divide problem-solving responsibilities.
- Cross-check calculations.
- Review each other's reasoning.
- Work on different aspects of a challenge simultaneously.

Participants may not communicate with or seek assistance from other teams.

- Sharing answers.
- Asking another team for assistance.
- Looking at another team's screen.
- Communicating answers through notes, messages, gestures, or other means.

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8 ANSWER SUBMISSION

Answers must be submitted through the designated interface on the Locked Files website. Participants should carefully check their answers before submitting them. The website may require answers in a particular format; participants must follow any formatting instructions provided with the question.

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9 THREE-ATTEMPT RULE

CORE RULE · Each question provides the team with a maximum of 3 attempts.

A correct answer within the three attempts will unlock the next question.

If all three attempts are incorrect, the team fails that quest and will not be permitted to proceed further through that sequence. Such a team will be treated as a non-completing team for final ranking.

Example:

- Attempt 1 → Incorrect; Attempt 2 → Incorrect; Attempt 3 → Correct → Question successfully cleared.
- Attempt 1 → Incorrect; Attempt 2 → Incorrect; Attempt 3 → Incorrect → Quest ends for that team.

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10 ATTEMPTS & RANKING

The number of attempts taken to successfully clear questions will be recorded by the Locked Files system and may be used for tie-breaking purposes. Participants are therefore encouraged to avoid unnecessary guesses.

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11 WINNING CRITERIA

11.1 Teams That Complete the Entire Sequence

The primary winner will be the team that successfully completes the entire quest in the shortest time. Rankings will be determined using the recorded completion timestamp of the final challenge.

TIE-BREAKER

If multiple teams complete the quest at the same time, the team with the lower total number of attempts required to clear the quest will rank higher. If a further tie remains, the organizers may use an additional tie-break mechanism.

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12 TEAMS THAT DO NOT COMPLETE THE SEQUENCE

A team may fail to complete the sequence because the team exhausts all three attempts on a question, or because the two-hour competition period ends before the team completes the sequence.

Such teams will be ranked based on:

1. Number of questions successfully answered.
2. If two or more teams have answered the same number of questions, the team that reached that number in the shorter amount of time will rank higher.

IN SIMPLE TERMS · More questions completed → better rank. If equal → faster completion time wins.

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13 FAIR PLAY & PROHIBITED CONDUCT

The following are strictly prohibited:

External assistance

- Internet searches unrelated to the Locked Files website.
- AI tools or chatbots.
- Online calculators or other external tools.
- Assistance from individuals outside the team.
- Unauthorized reference material.

Communication with other teams

- Sharing answers.
- Asking other teams for assistance.
- Viewing another team's screen.
- Communicating answers by any means.

Technical manipulation

- Bypassing a locked question.
- Accessing future questions without solving the preceding challenge.
- Inspecting hidden answers.
- Modifying website code or files.
- Exploiting vulnerabilities or bugs.
- Manipulating the answer-validation system.
- Accessing another team's account or progress.
- Circumventing browser monitoring.

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14 DISQUALIFICATION

A team may be immediately disqualified for serious violations, including:

- Unauthorized internet usage.
- Use of AI or external assistance.
- Deliberate circumvention of website restrictions.
- Accessing another team's information.
- Sharing answers with another team.
- Tampering with the competition platform.
- Deliberately interfering with another team's participation.
- Any other serious breach of competition integrity.

The organizers reserve the right to determine whether a particular action constitutes a disqualifying violation.

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15 TECHNICAL ISSUES

If a participant experiences a technical problem with the competition website or network environment, they must immediately notify an event volunteer.

Examples include:

- Website not loading.
- Question not appearing.
- Correct answer failing to unlock the next question.
- Network connectivity problems.
- Browser malfunction.
- Submission failure.
- Timer malfunction.

Participants must not attempt to resolve suspected website errors by manipulating the website, its code, browser developer tools, or other technical mechanisms.

The organizers will assess the issue and determine the appropriate remedy. Where necessary, the organizers may:

- Restore a team's state.
- Move the team to another system.
- Correct a technical error.
- Adjust the team's recorded time.
- Provide another reasonable remedy.

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16 EVENT SCHEDULE

TIME	ACTIVITY
5:30 PM	Participant reporting
5:30-5:45 PM	Seating and system preparation
5:45-5:50 PM	Rules and technical briefing
5:50 PM	Competition begins
7:50 PM	Competition ends
7:50 PM onwards	Result verification

The exact schedule may be adjusted by the organizers if required.

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17 IMPORTANT PARTICIPANT CHECKLIST

Participants should arrive with:

- Their own laptop
- Laptop charger
- Calculator
- Registered team members
- A working browser
- Sufficient battery
- Any other materials explicitly permitted by the organizers

Participants should not rely on internet searches, external websites, AI tools, or online resources during the competition.

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18 ORGANIZER'S AUTHORITY

The organizers reserve the right to:

- Modify the competition format where necessary.
- Replace or withdraw a defective question.
- Correct technical issues.
- Adjust timings in case of significant technical disruption.
- Investigate suspected malpractice.
- Apply penalties for rule violations.
- Disqualify teams for serious violations.

- Merge or restructure teams where considered necessary for the smooth and fair conduct of the competition.
- Make final decisions regarding disputes and tie-breaks.

All decisions made by the organizing committee regarding the conduct and outcome of the competition will be final and binding.

FILE_19 // FINAL TRANSMISSION

THE SPIRIT OF LOCKED FILES

There is no shortcut.

Every question is a lock.

Every answer is a key.

Think carefully.

Work together.

Manage your attempts.

Keep moving.

CAN YOU UNLOCK THEM ALL?

[ACCESS LEVEL: RESTRICTED] // CASE NO. LF-0826 // FINTECH AND QUANT
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